



The
University
Of
Sheffield.

Application 071912

Section A: Applicant details

Date application started:

Sun 23 November 2025 at 13:28

First name:

Edward

Last name:

Cox

Email:

ecox7@sheffield.ac.uk

Programme name:

Computer Science

Module name:

Dissertation

Last updated:

26/11/2025

Department:

Computer Science

Applying as:

Undergraduate

Research project title:

VCT Match Predictor: Utilising Alexa to Provide Intuitive Valorant Esports Predictions

Has your research project undergone academic review, in accordance with the appropriate process?

Yes

Similar applications:

- not entered -

Section B: Basic information

Supervisor

Name

Email

Roger Moore

r.k.moore@sheffield.ac.uk

Proposed project duration

Start date (of data collection):

Wed 3 December 2025

Anticipated end date (of project)

Sun 10 May 2026

3: Project code (where applicable)

Project externally funded?

No

Project code
- *not entered* -

Suitability

Takes place outside UK?

No

Involves NHS?

No

Health and/or social care human-interventional study?

No

ESRC funded?

No

Likely to lead to publication in a peer-reviewed journal?

No

Led by another UK institution?

No

Involves human tissue?

No

Clinical trial or a medical device study?

No

Involves social care services provided by a local authority?

No

Is social care research requiring review via the University Research Ethics Procedure

No

Involves adults who lack the capacity to consent?

No

Involves research on groups that are on the Home Office list of 'Proscribed terrorist groups or organisations'?

No

Indicators of risk

Involves potentially vulnerable participants?

No

Involves potentially highly sensitive topics?

No

Section C: Summary of research

1. Aims & Objectives

The aim of the project is to create a match predictor for the game Valorant, in specific for the VCT tournaments, where professional esports teams compete against each other in a globally broadcasted event. I will be analysing a dataset of match statistics and results using machine learning techniques to predict the results of future broadcasted matches. To make the final product intuitive and easy to use, I will be utilising Amazon Alexa as a means of hosting and communicating with the machine learning model.

2. Methodology

I will be searching the internet for a collated dataset that contains information about the match statistics and results for the globally broadcasted VCT tournaments in the game Valorant. I'm looking for data that has an extensive amount of features to do with the games played, such as the in-game names of the players who played, the teams they played for, how many eliminations and deaths they had per round. I will be searching for a dataset that is free to use, potentially requiring a citation, which I am happy to give, but ultimately without the need for explicit permission.

3. Personal Safety

Have you completed your departmental risk assessment procedures, if appropriate?

Yes

Raises personal safety issues?

No

The data is second hand, and contains information about events which were broadcasted worldwide. I will not be contacting anybody in relation to collecting or using the data, as it will be a dataset that somebody online has already put together, and is happy for others to use.

The nature of the dataset being video game match results doesn't realistically pose any safety issue or mental health issues to myself, or any other researchers.

Section D: About the participants

1. Potential Participants

I will not be needing participants, as the data is second hand, and collated from wiki pages about the VCT. The matches are publicly played, and all in the information is collected for me. I am just searching for a dataset. Data such as in-game names and the teams that they played for, which could be used to identify individuals is already publicly available and one google search away. The data is not private.

2. Recruiting Potential Participants

I will not be contacting participants. I will however ensure that the license associated with the dataset means that I am allowed to use it.

2.1. Advertising methods

Will the study be advertised using the volunteer lists for staff or students maintained by IT Services? No

- not entered -

3. Consent

Will informed consent be obtained from the participants? (i.e. the proposed process) No

There will be no participants.

4. Payment

Will financial/in kind payments be offered to participants? No

5. Potential Harm to Participants

What is the potential for physical and/or psychological harm/distress to the participants?

None.

How will this be managed to ensure appropriate protection and well-being of the participants?

I will not be contacting / interacting with anybody in searching for and analysing the data I gather. The data is to do with a trivial topic - video games.

6. Potential harm to others who may be affected by the research activities

Which other people, if any, may be affected by the research activities, beyond the participants and the research team?

I live in a flat with 6 other people, though I will not share specific details about the research being undertaken. Also, to my knowledge, none of them are vulnerable people, and they all play video games, so the nature of the data is not alarming to them.

What is the potential for harm to these people?

There is no potential for harm.

How will this be managed to ensure appropriate safeguarding of these people?

I will not discuss the research to them, which results in any potential harm to be avoided.

7. Reporting of safeguarding concerns or incidents

What arrangements will be in place for participants, and any other people external to the University who are involved in, or affected by, the research, to enable reporting of incidents or concerns?

I am not dealing with any participants, and my flatmates are not to be involved in my research. This is a totally individual research endeavour.

Who will be the Designated Safeguarding Contact(s)?

I am not dealing with any participants, and my flatmates are not to be involved in my research. This is a totally individual research endeavour.

How will reported incidents or concerns be handled and escalated?

I am not dealing with any participants, and my flatmates are not to be involved in my research. This is a totally individual research endeavour.

Section E: Personal data

1. Use of personal data

Will any personal data be processed or accessed as part of the project?

Yes

Will any 'special category' personal data be processed or accessed as part of the project?

No

Provide the number of people whose personal data you expect to process or access.

10000

2. Managing personal data

Which organisation(s) will act as data controller(s) of the personal data?

University of Sheffield only

Who will have access to the personal data?

Access to the dataset as a whole will be myself, but since the publicised nature of the player tags, the individuals who this data refers to have granted permission to RIOT games (the company that owns Valorant), "to copy, publish, distribute, edit, host, store, and otherwise use and display his or her full name, Riot ID, photograph, likeness, image, avatar, voice, video, in-game persona, game play statistics, and biographical information" (https://liquipedia.net/commons/images/6/69/VCT_-_Global_Competition_Policy_v2.0_-_2022.pdf). Findings from analysing the data will be published through my dissertation.

What measures, processes and/or agreements will be put in place to manage the personal data?

The individuals who the data is about have already granted the games company permission to publicise their personal data. I won't have access to any of their contact information, or more personal information than their player tag and the teams that they have played for.

Will all identifiable personal data in digital or physical format be destroyed within a defined period after the project has ended?

Yes

When will the identifiable personal data be destroyed?

Once my dissertation has been completed, published and I am awarded my degree, the data will be destroyed. However, it will still be available online, from a different source, since I found it second hand.

3. Third-party services

Will any external third-party services not provided by the University be used to process or access personal data during the project?

No

4. Security of computers, devices and software

Will personal data be processed or accessed on any computers or devices that are not managed by the University of Sheffield?

Yes

Will all computers and devices that are not managed by the University of Sheffield be secured in accordance with the IT Code of Connection?

Yes

Will any software not approved by the University of Sheffield be used to process or access data?

Yes

Will the software be secured in accordance with the IT Code of Connection?

Yes

Will any software be written or developed in order to process or access the personal data?

Yes

Will the new software be secured in accordance with the IT Code of Connection?

Yes

Section F: Supporting documentation

Information & Consent

Participant information sheets relevant to project?

No

Consent forms relevant to project?

No

Additional Documentation

External Documentation

- not entered -

Section G: Declaration

Signed by:

Edward Cox

Date signed:

Sun 23 November 2025 at 14:15

Official notes

- not entered -